100 courses took 12 years. Then 148 in one.

> What actually changed?

The CEO's memo: Duolingo goes 'AI-first'.

Luis von Ahn's all-staff email, shared on LinkedIn

Stop using contractors for work 'AI can handle'.

New headcount only if a team can't automate more.

148 new courses go live, built with AI.

FIRST 100 COURSES

~12 years

NEXT 148 COURSES

~1 year

Weeks later: the company is 'continuing to hire'.

- **Apr 28** Memo
- **Apr 30** 148 courses
- **May** Clarification

AI made the first draft nearly free.

What AI didn't replace:

🧭

Choosing what to build

🔍

Checking quality

✅

Owning the result

Give AI the draft. Keep the judgment.

1. Pick one weekly task
2. Let AI write the first draft
3. Spend your time checking and improving